



Pride of the nation: Avani Lekhara successfully defended her title, setting a new Paralympic record at the 2024 Paris Paralympics. This triumph makes her only the second Indian para-athlete to achieve the remarkable feat of winning multiple Paralympic gold medals.

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After Manish Narwal added a silver medal to the tally in men's 10m air pistol SH1, Rubina Francis capped off the show with a bronze medal in women's air pistol SH1.

The birth of a league

Immediately after the conclusion of the Summer Games, the National Rifle Association of India (NRAI), the body that governs shooting in India, elected Kalikesh Narayan Singh Deo as its president at the General Body meeting held at the Constitution Club in New Delhi in September.

One of Kalikesh's first steps was to announce the launch of a franchise league under the moniker Shooting League of India (SLI). The proposal has received approval from the Governing Body, and the inaugural edition is likely to take place in March 2025. But even as shooting gears up to receive a massive boost in India, thanks to the SLI, its fortunes globally took a severe beating after its exclusion from the multi-discipline rosters of the 2026 Commonwealth Games in Glasgow and the Youth Olympics in Dakar.

IN 2025...

Although the sport's exclusion from the CWG and the Youth Olympics would have the shooting fraternity largely disappointed, the onset of a new Olympic cycle only means there's plenty to look forward to in 2025.

Most shooters would be eager to work towards the World Championships in October-November in Malakasa (shotgun) and Cairo (rifle, pistol). The Asian Championship between August 16 and 30 in Shymkent, Kazakhstan, is another event that would have them keenly interested.

The Paris Olympians would return to action at the selection trials around mid-February. These trials would decide one's eligibility for making the national team ahead of the season's first World Cups in rifle, pistol, and shotgun in Buenos Aires and Lima in April.

India is also set to host a Junior World Cup this year. The ISSF, in a written communication, has mentioned two possible windows in the calendar to slot the competition between September and early November.